TF-P1 · POCKET

CASSETTE PLAYER FOR .CASS TAPES

OWNER'S GUIDE

Everything you need to play TAPE·FOUR cassettes on your phone or computer: what a cassette is, how to get one, where to keep it, and how to play it.



IPHONE · ANDROID · WINDOWS · MACOS · LINUX

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1 WELCOME

The TF-P1 Pocket is a personal cassette player, like the one you might have carried in the 1980s, except that it lives on your phone or computer. It plays **.cass** cassettes: tapes recorded on TAPE·FOUR, the four-track cassette recorder.

A .cass file is not an ordinary music file. It is a complete cassette: the tape itself, with everything recorded on it, and what the cassette looks like. The Pocket shows you that cassette, with its shell and its handwritten label, and plays it the way a good portable cassette player would.



The Pocket on a computer. The cassette at a real cassette's size; the keys sit in two rows underneath.

WHAT MAKES IT DIFFERENT

IT PLAYS THE TAPE, NOT A RECORDING OF IT.

Every cassette keeps its own character: its brand of tape, its hiss, the noise reduction it was recorded with, its age and how much it has been played. Two cassettes with the same song on them can sound different, as real ones do.

TWO SIDES, LIKE A REAL CASSETTE.

Play side A to the end, then turn the cassette over and play side B. The Pocket remembers which side was up and where you stopped, for every cassette.

YOU CAN SEE THE TAPE MOVE.

The tape winds from the left spool to the right as it plays, so you can see at a glance how far through the side you are and how much is left.

EACH CASSETTE LOOKS LIKE ITSELF.

The cassette's shell, its colours and the label written on it travel inside the file, so a tape looks the same on every phone and computer it is played on.

IT NEVER HARMS YOUR TAPES.

Real cassettes wear a little every time they are played. The Pocket only reads a cassette. It never records on it, wears it or changes the file.

ONE FILE HOLDS THE WHOLE TAPE.

Copy it, back it up, or send it to a friend, and they get exactly the cassette you have.

2 HOW A CASSETTE WORKS

You don't need to know any of this to enjoy the Pocket. But a cassette behaves differently from a music file, and knowing why makes it more fun.

A RIBBON OF TAPE BETWEEN TWO SPOOLS

Inside a cassette is a long, thin ribbon of tape wound between two spools. When you press **PLAY**, the tape is pulled past the player's head from the left spool to the right one, slowly, at the same speed every cassette player in the world uses. The sound is stored along the tape, so to get to a song you wind the tape to it: fast forward or rewind, as on a real cassette player. There is no jumping straight to a track.

On the Pocket you see this happen. At the start of a side, nearly all the tape is on the left spool. As it plays, the left spool shrinks and the right one grows. The tape always moves past the head at the same speed, so the small spool has to turn faster than the big one, and you can see that too.

At each end of the tape is a few seconds of clear plastic leader, which carries no sound. A cassette that is fully rewound plays a few seconds of silence before the music starts, just like a real one.

SIDE A AND SIDE B

The tape is only half used by each side. Side A is recorded along one half of the tape's width, and side B along the other half, running the other way. When side A finishes, all the tape is on the right spool; turn the cassette over and that full spool is now on the left, ready to play side B. That's why the Pocket always shows which side is up, and why the label shows `A` or `B`.



Side B up. The label shows B, and the tape now runs from what was the right spool.

LENGTH

The number on a cassette is how many minutes of tape it holds, both sides together: a C-60 plays for 30 minutes a side, a C-90 for 45, a C-46 for 23. A side doesn't have to be full. The Pocket simply plays silence where nothing was recorded, as a real cassette would.

TAPE TYPES

Cassettes come in different kinds of tape, and each kind has its own sound. TAPE·FOUR makes four:

TAPE	KIND	WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE
BASIC	Normal (type I), the everyday tape	Warm, with the most hiss. Loud, bright sounds soften.
SD	Normal (type I), a better one	Clear and lively, with less hiss.
XR	Chrome (type II)	Crisp treble and low hiss.
MX	Metal (type IV)	The cleanest of the four: the least hiss and the most clarity.

A real player needs to know which kind of tape is in it, so it can play it back with the right tone. Cassettes have small notches on top that tell the player, and the Pocket reads them too: it sets itself for each cassette automatically. There is nothing for you to set.

HISS, AND NOISE REDUCTION

All tape has a faint background hiss, like a quiet "shhh" between songs. It's part of the sound of a cassette, and the Pocket keeps it. How much you hear depends on the tape type, and on the cassette's age and condition.

To reduce the hiss, a recording can be made with **noise reduction** (NR). It works in two halves: when the cassette is recorded, the quiet parts are made a little louder and brighter; when it's played, the player turns them back down, and the hiss goes down with them. The two halves have to match. The Pocket knows every system TAPE·FOUR records with, and plays each cassette with the one it was recorded with. The key shows which: `NR 2:1`, `NR B` or `NR C`.

TRY IT

Press the NR key to switch noise reduction off (`NR OFF`). A cassette recorded with noise reduction now sounds brighter and hissier, as it would on a player without it. Some people prefer it that way, which is fine. Press it again to switch it back on.

AGE AND WEAR

A cassette made in TAPE·FOUR can be new, or it can be given some history: a little more hiss, the odd dropout where the tape coating is thin, slightly dull treble. That history is part of the cassette and plays the same on every player. The Pocket's own mechanism adds a touch of the gentle wobble in pitch (called wow and flutter) that every portable player has. It's small, and it's what makes it sound like a cassette rather than a file.

3 GETTING CASSETTES

Cassettes are made on TAPE·FOUR. You can make your own, or play ones other people send you.

FROM TAPE·FOUR

TAPE·FOUR saves any cassette as a .cass file:

- **A finished mix.** When you mix your songs down in TAPE·FOUR, they go onto a stereo *master tape*, which has two sides like any cassette. Open the master deck and press **EXPORT .CASS**. This is usually the cassette you want on your phone.
- **A four-track tape.** With the cassette in the deck, press **EJECT** and choose **EXPORT AS A .CASS FILE**. The Pocket plays a four-track tape as it is, with all four tracks at once, unmixed.

TAPE·FOUR asks where to save the file, starting in `Documents/TapeFour`.

FROM SOMEONE ELSE

A .cass file can be shared like any other file: by email, in a messaging app, through a cloud drive (iCloud Drive, Google Drive, Dropbox, OneDrive), with AirDrop, or on a USB stick. Whoever receives it gets the same cassette, sound and looks included.

CASSETTES ARE BIG

A cassette holds the whole tape, so the file is large: about 460 MB for a C-60 and about 690 MB for a C-90, and about 350 MB for a C-46. Most email services won't send files that size. Use a cloud drive or a file-sending service, and share the link instead. Downloading a cassette on a phone is best done on Wi-Fi.

4 PUTTING A CASSETTE IN

ON AN IPHONE OR IPAD

1. Find the .cass file: in the Files app, an email, Messages, or wherever it was sent.
2. Tap it, then tap the share button and choose **TF-P1 Pocket**. (In the Files app you can also tap and hold the file and choose **Share**.)
3. The Pocket opens, copies the cassette into its own folder, and puts it in, ready to play.

You can also copy cassettes straight into the Pocket's folder in the Files app, under `On My iPhone › TF-P1 Pocket`, from a computer or a cloud drive. The next time you open the Pocket they appear on the cassette shelf, newest first.

ON AN ANDROID PHONE OR TABLET

1. Find the .cass file: in your Files or Downloads app, in an email, or in a messaging app.
2. Tap it and choose **TF-P1 Pocket** when Android asks which app to open it with.
3. The Pocket copies the cassette into its own storage and puts it in, ready to play.

Or, in the Pocket, tap the cassette to show the keys, tap **CASSETTES**, then **OPEN**, and pick the file.

WHILE IT COPIES

Copying a big cassette takes a few seconds, and the screen says `COPYING THE CASSETTE...` meanwhile. If it says `COULD NOT COPY THE CASSETTE`, check that the phone has enough free space (a cassette needs several hundred MB), or that the file finished downloading.

ON A COMPUTER

Any of these puts a cassette in:

- Drag a .cass file onto the Pocket's window.
- Click **CASSETTES**, then **OPEN**, and choose the file.
- On a Mac, double-click a .cass file. On Windows or Linux, right-click it and choose **Open with** and the Pocket; you can tell your computer to always open .cass files with it.

On a computer the Pocket plays the cassette where it is: it doesn't make a copy. Its window shows the cassette at the size of a real one, 100.4 by 63.8 mm, going by the screen size your computer reports. Macs and most Linux systems know their screens' real size; Windows reports only its display scaling, so there the cassette is true to size only on a screen of about 96 pixels to the inch at 100 % scaling, and a little larger or smaller on others.

5 KEEPING YOUR CASSETTES

THE CASSETTE SHELF

Every cassette you play goes on the shelf. Tap **CASSETTES** to see it: the most recently played first, each with its own shell and label. Tap one to put it in. It starts where you left it, on the side you left up.



The cassette shelf. Your cassettes, the most recently played first. The one in the player is marked.

The shelf holds your 24 most recently played cassettes. Playing an older one puts it back at the front. When the Pocket opens, it puts back in the cassette you were last listening to.

The **THEME** key on the shelf changes the Pocket's colours: Teal VFD, Cobalt, Mono, or Red / green, in turn. Your choice is remembered. It colours the player, not the cassettes.

WHERE THE FILES LIVE

iPhone, iPad	In the Pocket's own folder, which the Files app shows under `On My iPhone › TF-P1 Pocket`. To remove a cassette, delete it there; to back it up, copy it from there.
Android	In the Pocket's own private storage. Other apps can't see it, and it doesn't fill your Documents or Downloads with big files. Uninstalling the Pocket removes these copies, so keep the originals somewhere (on a computer or in a cloud drive).
Computer	Wherever you keep them; the Pocket plays them from there. If you move or rename a cassette, it disappears from the shelf the next time you tap it there. Open it again from its new place and it goes back on.

GOOD HABIT

Keep one folder for your cassettes on your computer or in a cloud drive, and treat it as your tape collection. Phones come and go; the folder stays.

6 PLAYING

ON A PHONE: TAP THE CASSETTE

Hold the phone sideways. The cassette fills the screen. **Tap anywhere on the cassette to show the keys, and tap again to hide them**, so you can watch the tape go round. When you first put a cassette in, the keys show so you can see where they are.



Playing, keys hidden. Just the cassette.



Keys showing. Transport and the side display along the bottom; turn over and cassettes on the left; volume and noise reduction on the right.

THE KEYS

KEY	WHAT IT DOES
◀◀ **Rewind**	Winds the tape back towards the start of the side. Like a real player, it starts slowly and speeds up as the spool it's winding onto fills; a whole side takes a couple of minutes. Press **STOP** to end it, or **PLAY** to listen as it winds (see below).
■ **Stop**	Stops the tape.
▶ **Play**	Plays. The key lights while the tape is playing. At the end of a side the tape stops by itself.
▶▶ **Fast forward**	Winds the tape on towards the end of the side, the same way.
TURN OVER	Takes the cassette out, turns it over and puts it back in: side B if side A was up, and the other way round. The tape stops first. The place on the tape stays the same, seen from the other side.
CASSETTES	Opens the cassette shelf (chapter 5).
NR	Noise reduction on or off (chapter 2). When it's on, it shows the system the cassette was recorded with.
+ / −, VOL	The volume, 0 to 10.

FINDING YOUR PLACE

Like most personal cassette players, the Pocket has no counter. The display shows only which side is up (`SIDE A` or `SIDE B`). You see where you are from the spools: at the start of a side the tape is nearly all on the left, halfway through the two spools are the same size, and near the end it's nearly all on the right.

To find a song, listen while you wind. Press fast forward or rewind once: the tape winds at about a third of full speed with the head touching it lightly, and you hear it faintly, high-pitched going forward and backwards going back (cue and review). The display shows `CUE` or `REVIEW`. The gaps between songs stand out as short silences. Press **PLAY** to play from there. Press the same wind key again to wind at full speed, silently; the other wind key reverses and keeps listening.

VOLUME

On a phone, the Pocket has just one volume, the phone's own media volume. The phone's side buttons and the Pocket's **+** and **−** keys change the same thing, and the number on screen always shows where it is. On a computer the Pocket has its own volume slider, separate from the computer's.

ON A COMPUTER

The keys sit in a row under the cassette, with the side display and the volume slider. The keyboard works too:

KEY	DOES
`Space`	Play / stop
`→`	Fast forward
`←`	Rewind

KEY	DOES
↑ / ↓	Volume up / down
Esc	Close the cassette shelf

LEAVING AND COMING BACK

Whenever you close the Pocket or switch to another app, it remembers the cassette, the side and the place. Next time, the same cassette is in, on the same side, where you left it.

7 QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

QUESTION	ANSWER
I press PLAY and hear nothing.	Check the volume (the number on screen) and the phone's silent switch or the computer's sound output. At the very start of a side the leader takes a few seconds to pass. Then look at the spools: the tape may be on a part of the side where nothing was recorded. Rewind, or turn the cassette over.
Side B is silent.	Not every cassette has something on side B. A four-track tape from TAPE·FOUR uses the whole width of the tape for its four tracks, so it has no separate side B: turned over, it plays its tracks backwards, as a real four-track tape does.
It says `COULD NOT OPEN`.	The file isn't a complete cassette. It may not have finished downloading or copying, or it may not be a .cass file at all. Get a fresh copy and try again.
The cassette looks plain, or different from how it looked in TAPE·FOUR.	A cassette from an early version of TAPE·FOUR may not carry its look. The Pocket then draws the standard shell for its tape type, with its label. Exporting it again from a current TAPE·FOUR fixes it.
It sounds dull, or the hiss rises and falls.	Check the NR key. Normally leave it on: the Pocket then uses the system the cassette was recorded with. With NR off a cassette recorded with noise reduction sounds bright and hissy; that's expected.
The pitch wobbles slightly.	That's the Pocket's mechanism: a small amount of wow and flutter, as every portable cassette player has. An old or worn cassette can add a little more of its own.
A cassette has vanished from the shelf.	On a computer the file was moved, renamed or deleted; open it from its new place. On a phone, the shelf keeps the 24 most recently played; copy the cassette in again to bring an older one back.
Can I record with the Pocket?	No. It's a player: it never changes a cassette. Record on TAPE·FOUR.

8 SPECIFICATIONS

Model	TF-P1 Pocket, stereo cassette player
Plays	.cass cassette files (version 1): TAPE·FOUR master tapes (stereo, two sides) and four-track tapes
Tape types	Normal (type I), chrome (type II) and metal (type IV); set automatically from the cassette
Tape speed	4.76 cm/s (1⅞ in/s), the standard cassette speed
Wow and flutter	0.18 % wow, 0.12 % flutter, like a good portable
Speed accuracy	+0.4 %, a portable's typical slight haste
Frequency response	Heads to about 14 kHz
Noise reduction	2:1 compander, sliding band B, sliding band C: the one each cassette was recorded with; switchable off
Volume	0 to 10. Phones: the phone's media volume (side buttons and on-screen keys). Computers: the player's own
Fast wind	About 110 seconds for a side of a C-60; the tape speeds up as it winds
Cue and review	Fast forward or rewind pressed once: the tape heard faintly as it passes. Pressed again: full speed
Counter	None (the display shows the side)
Memory	The side and place of each of the last 24 cassettes played
Runs on	iPhone and iPad, Android phones and tablets (Android 7 or later), Windows, macOS, Linux

TAPE·FOUR and the TF-P1 Pocket are made by 78Hz. The .cass format is open and documented, so other programs can make cassettes the Pocket plays.